Halfling Bard Brothers presents

Above the Mines of Mirabar

Orvanath's Secret

A 7-hour adventure for 6th to 8th level characters

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Introduction

Welcome, Dungeon Master, to your first foray into the Tales of the Halfling Bard Brotherhood! We've traveled Faerûn and searched every crevice, listened to every townsfolk with a tale, and independently verified all accounts to deliver to you the forgotten stories of the Forgotten Realms. In these pages you'll hear a harrowing tale of a cursed family in need of recovery and the blueprint to adapt their rescue to your own narrative. From the dark Mines of Mirabar to the crest of the Spine of the World, your party will follow a path none have tread in centuries and confront a place from which only one has ever returned.

Those adventurers with 6-8 seasons of experience should be able to return heroes (barring any unforeseen avalanches, snowstorms, or multi-dimensional arcane rifts). We've separated the story into 3 Acts, as most good tales are. Keep the pace quick, and your wit even more so, and you'll give your party a night or two full of heroics and adventure.

That's what it's all about, right?

We begin our story on an overcast and humid day, just before midday, outside the gates of Mirabar. The party is approached with a plea to cure a group of cursed families. The families' ancestors were adventurers in Northern Faerûn about 200 years ago, and were killed on their quest up the mountains. The family needs the souls of their ancestors, adventurers in an older era, finally laid to rest before their curse can be lifted. There is a handsome reward put forth by all the families, and that's attracted the attention of a diverse group of adventurers.

Little does the party know, 220 years ago, this family's ancestor belonged to an adventuring company named Bright Banner Brandished. A group of members took advantage of a slim window of time during an unusually warm season (much like present day...) to enter a usually frozen-over ancient crypt somewhere in the Spine of the World. They traversed the ice caverns deep into the mountainside, and found themselves confronted with the inhabitant of the crypt-- Orvanath, a powerful Lich. Most of the party were turned into wights by Orvanath, destined to protect the dungeon for eternity. Only one member, the wizard Ashemmi, was able to survive. She left very few clues as to the location of the crypt, but the receding ice has divulged Orvanath's greatest secret once again, the location of his phylactery! Can this party, 220 years later, free the members of Bright Banner Brandished from their wretched servitude, remove their families' curse, and destroy the phylactery of Orvanath? Only if the party is at its most cunning will they be able to achieve their goals without attracting the deadly attention of Orvanath.

Everything you need to guide your adventurers through this story is in the pages that follow. Purple boxes are meant to be read allowed to the players in their context, and the maps have been made as simple as possible to make sure the pace of this tale is quick! My brother and I have risked our hairs and hides to collect this information for you, gathered journals from treacherous peaks and befriended horrors for corroboration-- here's hoping that your telling is as exciting as it was to put together!

Happy and Harrowing Adventures,

The Halfling Bard Brothers

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Act I
A Humble Plea from Noble Birth
-or-
The Mark of Orvanath

Even as the sun warms the mountain, I am cold with dread. Emory hasn't spoken in a day. He won't say what we're after. I can only imagine the horrors that wait for us in the center of the Spine of the World, and I pray that whatever we're after isn't the treasure of something out of our league... *-Ashemmi's Journal*

The adventure begins in **Mirabar**, the richest city in the North. Nestled between the Mirar River and the Long Road to its South and East, Mirabar is the last bastion of what some would truly consider to be society south of the World's Spine. While Mirabar is a city of great import and consequential history, on the day of the party's arrival something especially strange seems to be going on: 2 large families from across the North have arrived at Mirabar's gates, seeking desperate assistance in a grave matter. Noble, but not squandering opportunity, the heads of the families approach adventurers, mercenaries, and clerics alike, as they are all cursed, and they seek a cure.

Plighted Families

A bit of a crowd has begun to form around the afflicted families, and anyone gawking along the bustling road outside of Mirabar can point the party in the direction of the heads of the families. They ride atop their horses, leading wagons for each family and a few stragglers on foot. There are about 100 in all. A few members of the group appear healthy, but still sullen-faced from long journeys. Others appear stricken with a terrible illness --gaunt cheeks, bloated stomachs, and black sores swelling atop their skin. The damnedest among them seem to exude a putrid aura, and any players who come within a

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The Highdale and Rightsfeld Families

Family Member	Affiliation	Description
Larissa Highdale	Human matriarch of House Highdale	Widow of the late Lord Highdale, who succumbed to the curse, charismatic Larissa convinced her kin to join with the Rightsfelds to seek a cure. She reveals that the Highdales and Rightsfelds are descendants of the forsaken adventuring company Bright Bannered Brandished, who perished 220 years ago after adventuring near Mirabar. Larissa mentions they found a journal and points the party to Emory to learn more about it while she waits for the arrival of the dwarf cleric they came to see.
Margan Eisenheart	Dwarf steward to the Highdale family	Margan, whose ancestor was also among the damned Bright Banner Brandished, has lived his life in service to the Highdales, as his father and many more before them did. It was Margan who made contact with a dwarf cleric of Dumathoin here in Mirabar who may be able to help the families. Margan is stricken with the curse, but it has bearly shown its fangs due to his high constitution.
Daniel Highdale	Human nephew of Larissa Highdale	Stricken with the curse, Daniel's sister Petra has done extensive research and keeps his curse under control, but the healing is constant and costly. Half of Daniel's body is covered with necrotic tissue.
Emory Rightsfeld II	Human patriarch of House Rightsfeld	The namesake of one of the leaders of the Bright Banner Brandished, it has been Emory's life's goal to release his family from the curse. He tells the party that he found an old journal from the adventuring company up north, beyond the Mines of Mirabar, and that he was able to gain passage through a shortcut in the mines due to his connections in Mirabar. Emory also suffers from the curse, but it barely seems to affect him.
Petra Rightsfeld	Human wife of Emory Rightsfeld II, younger sister of Daniel Highdale	Born a member of House Highdale, Petra married into the Rightsfeld family and suffers the curse--her first instance of corrupted flesh appeared six months ago, prompting Emory to begin to enact his plans with Larissa and find a cure. Learned in the arcane arts, Petra believes that the curse is a direct result of knots in the Weave among the descendants of the Bright Banner Brandished due to their posthumous torture. Due to her good nature, she's focused on healing her brother Daniel and as many of those who are closer to death, instead of being too concerned for herself.
Willem Rightsfeld	Human cousin of Emory Rightsfeld II	To Willem, not yet stricken with the curse, it's obvious that the gods just don't want these families around. Sour and obnoxious, Willem is not happy to be on this journey after losing his young wife and parents, and just wants to go home.

foot or so must made a **Constitution Save (DC 10)** in order to not lose his or her most recent meal. A *Detect Magic* spell or very well-informed **Intelligence (Arcana)** check **(DC 20)** will alert the party that this omen appears to be necrotic magic in origin. The group of families has been outside the gates about half an hour now. Asking anyone what's going on, be they guards or Mirabarrans, will direct the party to speak to the people who appear to be the leaders of the pitiful caravan.

The party eventually pieces together from any combination of people listed in the table above that the curse appears to be a ripple in the Weave—they believe that their ancestors are being tortured in their deaths in a way so great that the Weave itself has twisted along their progeny. To recap for the Dungeon Master, all of the family members are descended from the unlucky members of the adventuring company **Bright Banner Brandished**, who perished adventuring around Mirabar 220 years ago. The sole survivor, elf wizard Ashemmi, turned tail at the first indication of danger.

Cleric of Dumathoin

By the time the party is done asking their questions of the family members, **Branthum, Dwarven Cleric of Dumathoin**, has approached the scene escorted by two guards and brandishing a thick cloth over his mouth. He keeps a wide berth from the families even when addressing them. The players can overhear him talking with **Larissa** and **Margen** (**Perception DC 13**):

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"Dumathoin has told me of your families' plight, but the god of the buried keeps his secrets close. Fortunately, the Council of Sparkling Stones has allowed me to study the journal you claim to have found in hopes that we can uncover the origin of your troubles. Time is of the essence, however, as there are far too few healers here in Mirabar to rescue in time all those that are stricken. You'll need to hire outside help if this disease is to be lifted quickly."

Sensing, correctly of course, that the party is made up of hard, adventurous folk who wouldn't mind a quest (right?), **Branthum** invites the party to peruse the journal that he was handed to pique their interest. He sends **Margan** off to advise the other family heads that they've met the man they sought. If the party did not determine during earlier conversation with the families that putting the souls of the damned to final rest would remove the curse, now is a good time for **Branthum** to share that theory. He points out the final entry in the journal, dated 1371 Dalereckoning, 220 years prior:

Branthum tells the players that the journal was found under thin ice after the glacier receded North, among the blades of the World's Spine. It was uncovered during a dangerous excursion headed by the Highdale and Rightsfeld families last week. At this point, if the party isn't aware already, **Larissa** confirms that over the course of the past two centuries, all of the families were able to determine that they were descended from a group of ill-fated adventurers belonging to the **Bright Banner Brandished**, an adventuring company who set off for the North and were never heard from again. **Margan, Emory, and Larissa** all went to the area their ancestors once tread in hopes of finding the source of their curse. After they found the journal, they knew they were on the right path, but as they got further up the mountain, closer to their ancestors' resting place, they began to fall ill. The final destination of the **Bright Banner Brandished** is still unknown to the families, and is much higher up the mountains than any member of the families anticipated.

Below the writing in the final journal entry was scrawled a crude map of Mirabar's northern reaches, up to and across the Spine. A faded black line drawn across the brittle page ends at a cavern drawn into the mountainside, leading the party to assume their new destination.

At this point, **Margan** returns to **Larissa**, but with a group of four other people—adventurers, by the looks of it—in tow.

The Silver Hook Distraction

Margan whispers in **Larissa's** ear, and gives your players' characters a side glance. He tells **Larissa** that this party claims to be very familiar with the area to the North, and might even know the cavern of which they speak. The players can eavesdrop with a successful **Wisdom (Perception)** check (**DC 20**), otherwise the first thing they hear is **Larissa** speak, loudly, to **Margan**:

"In that case, we should enlist both groups of adventurers. Surely, they're used to collaborating in dire times--"

She's cut off by the braggadocious leader of the other party, **Gherhart Pine**. He scoffs as he eyes the player party:

"The Silver Hook doesn't work with outside companies. We'll be claiming the full reward for ourselves."

If the players happen to point out they're not with an "adventuring company", **Gherhart** retorts with:

"Well, we definitely don't work with amateurs."

Larissa responds dismissively, as she has no time to waste:

"However and by whomever it's done, all that matters is that our ancestors are put to rest. The Highdales and the Rightsfelds are proud people, but in this moment we beg of you a great task. Return with proof that your party were the heroes who lifted the curse, and the 10,000 gold reward is yours, as well as the eternal gratitude of myself and my kin. Best get a move on, now, the road is rough and wagon rentals are increasingly harder to come by, and the glacial melt could only last a few weeks at best before freezing again,

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Gherhart spits in the direction of the party:

> **"If you all end up making it back, you can buy us a congratulatory mead."**

He whispers something to a Tiefling to his left. A successful **Wisdom (Perception) or Wisdom (Insight) (DC 15)** will result in the players either seeing **Gherhart** covertly point at the journal, or give them a gut feeling that he knows where to get more information on the location.

The **Silver Hook** turns to leave, but **Gherhart** doesn't pass up the chance to rile the party a little more:

> **"Oh, fair warning, we see you following us and our professional courtesy will be suspended. Don't get in our way."**

He flashes a smile and catches back up with **the Silver Hook**.

DUNGEON MASTER NOTE:

Okay, we realize that not every party is able to be insulted without shedding the joker's blood. We get it. The purpose of the Silver Hook is to give the players an urgent perspective, and keep them on their toes. There will be opportunities in the future to come to blows with Gherhart's party (you didn't think we'd disappoint you there, did you?), so adapt the level of Gherhart's obnoxiousness to your player's style. Get under their skin with him, but not literally.

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The Archives of Mirabar

At this point, the party has a few options: they can take what little they know and get a head start in front of **the Silver Hook**, or they can do a little more investigating to narrow down the location of the northern crypt and prepare more effectively. A successful **Intelligence (Investigation)** check **(DC 15)** (or an idea from the party) will lead them to Mirabar's Archives. There are many sections that the literature and records are divided into, and each has its own set of rules and guards.

If the party wants to take the chance, they can also follow **Gherhart** and his crew (although they were specifically "asked" not to...). If they do, it will be difficult to navigate the streets of Mirabar while keeping track of them and staying unseen at the same time. Whoever is keeping tabs on **the Silver Hook** will need to keep them within sight while keeping to the shadows themselves. If the party is caught tailing **Gherhart**, they'll deliberately split up to confuse them, and eventually report them to the guards for harassment, using that distraction to escape the party.

If they're followed unawares, **the Silver Hook** will lead the party to the **Archives of Mirabar** themselves.

If the party doesn't shadow **Gehrhart's** group into the Archives and arrive there on their own, the Archive docent **Mallar Goldswayne** (dwarf) can advise them that whatever they're seeking (whether they ask about the **Bright Banner Brandished** or something else should make no difference) is in the sub-basement, which is off-limits to civilians.

The player party can choose to sneak past the 2 guards, or else bribe them: 10 gold per person should do it--Mirabar is heavily guarded after all. Deep within the sub-basement is a dark and damp wing devoted to adventuring company archives. No records are allowed to be removed from the archive, but the parties can copy down any information they find. If the party followed **the Silver Hook** down into the archives, they can hide and wait for them to leave, having noticed where they found information. If they made it here on their own, they'll need to make **Intelligence (Investigation)** checks **(DC 15)** to locate beneficial information within half an hour, **DC 10** to find it in an hour, and if they fail they can

Information on the Bright Banner Brandished

The Bright Banner Brandished had 5 members, but after the tragedy concerning the Rightsfelds and Highdale's ancestors, prospective recruits rarely mentioned it again... or went missing, themselves.
The Bright Banner Brandished purchased custom masterwork climbing gear before their excursion. An old ledger can be found with records of all the company's purchases. In the final days before the quest to the North, the group outfitted themselves with lots of survival gear, as well as 5-10 scrolls. The scrolls included **Fireball**, **Teleport**, **Cure Wounds (4x)**, and some unnamed. On the very last page, a quick note is scribbled stating that 50 gold was taken from the company war chest for the purpose of a wagonride, and what's left to be used for bribes through the mines. The note was scribbled quickly and signed, but the signature has been scorched off the page.
A map of the Spine of the World is folded in the back of the Bright Banner Brandished's ledger. It was obviously completed hurriedly and on location. It shows paths up the mountain above the Mines of Mirabar that normally are covered in ice and snow. It's dated just before the old adventurers left, and signed by a **Gronni Eisenheart**. A faded red 'X' marks a spot near the peak of an especially imposing mountain.
A manifest of the Bright Banner Brandished's lifetime members can be found, as well as adventuring logs, which can be fascinating. However, details regarding this last treacherous trip are not to be found, except for a single entry that reads the names of those who travelled: Brendan Highdale, Emory Rightsfeld, Milli Quickstepp, Gronni Eisenheart, and one more name that has been scorched off of the page.

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spend 5 hours and locate all of what they need. On a **20** or greater, they can not only narrow down where the **Bright Banner Brandished** was headed, but can use old maps to plot a course that should take a day off of their journey. Below is a table of possible information they can find that we'll trust you to dole out to those with successes in an interesting manner:

Once the players decide where they're going, supply themselves, and ready the group to leave, they can head toward the mines to the North.

Onward to the Mines!

If you aren't familiar with Mirabar, there's plenty to read into in other sources, but here's the long and short of it: Mirabar is dependent on its mines for its economy. They supply Adamantine to much of Faerûn, and originally having been a Dwarf settlement, take their gigantic mines very seriously. Anybody making their way towards them will be met with great scrutiny and will have to establish a believable cause to be traveling there. Should you have any need to use the guards, the **Axe of Mirabar**, an extended stat block can be found in *Storm King's Thunder*, page 98, but the basics are that they are shield dwarves with AC 18 plate armor, 67 hit points, with a Constitution score of 18, and prefer axes to swords. Other pertinent Dwarf information can be found in the *Player's Handbook*, page 20.

If they can't think of one, or fail their attempt, they can try to make it undetected through the foothills and sneak in--although that would be extremely time consuming and very difficult due to the number of guards on patrol. The party's best bet is to ask someone for a contact in the mine. So far, if they talked to him, they know that **Emory** recently made it through with his excursion, so they could go to him for the name of someone to get them in, or to **Larissa** to ask about those wagons she mentioned might be available for hire. They could also ask **Branthum**, the Temple Cleric, as he has contacts from his divine work through the city, and may even be able to obtain a writ of passage from the **Council of Sparkling Stones**-- though that would take a day at least. More creative solutions can be found by players, obviously. It's possible that they'll disguise themselves as transporters for raw Adamantine. The dice have their say, too, as we all know. The party could say "*nah, we'll just drive up there and walk in*", and end up using their **Charisma (Deception)** skill surprisingly well. Regardless of how they penetrate the mines, you should just make sure that their passage onward is believable. The next step is the exciting one, anyhow.

The Mine Ride

Once the group is in the **Mines of Mirabar**, they can use the information gathered (or gather more from the miners) to find their way to the upward passageway. You don't have to make a huge to-do about this leg of the journey, it's just as easy to say "*You find your way through the mines to a section where very few workers are. Down a gradually shrinking corridor you see a giant staircase leading upwards, and 2 heavily armored Dwarven guards standing in its opening.*"

If you want to lead them a little more through the mines, that's totally fine. After all, this is your group's story, and you know them better than anyone. You can have them speak to a few Dwarven miners to get directions or learn rumors of what lies beyond in the cavern. You could have them sneak around the guards, and track or use survival to make their way through wandering corridors beating with rhythmic metal clangs--- anything you want to establish the tone you're looking for. Personally, as bards, we focus mostly on the extraordinary portions of quests, and even mines as glorious as Mirabar's are, after all, mundane.

Deep under the mountains where the mines lie, a staircase was discovered more than 4 centuries ago. These steps led to an ancient Stone Giant Temple, desolate for centuries even then.

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Truly lost to time, this structure was magnificant to behold. That is, until around 100 years ago when Miribarran miners decided to expand their tunnels into the temple. They laid track for carts and began excavation, but only 5 months into production, the temple began to "fight back." Miners were taken into the shadows, halls began to collapse, and giant holes swallowed tons of minerals whole. Some say that the gods were displeased with what they saw to be the desecration of an ancient temple, some say that what drove the Dwarves out of their new mines is the same force that must have driven out the Giants long ago. Still other skeptics argue that the stonework inside wasn't intended to house a mine, so collapse was inevitable.

No matter what your party believes about why this portion of the mine was abandoned, they'll need to move through it if they want to drastically reduce their travel time to their destination. They're adventurers after all, what's a little unknown danger in exchange for reward?

However they get past the guards (stealth, distraction, violence, gold ...et cetera) they'll still climb the same staircase. 40' wide and 40' tall, this staircase was hewn from its former Giant-sized steps into a more manageable Dwarven path, and the right side has been turned into a ramp and laid with mine-cart track. When they reach the top of the stairs (some 20 minutes later...) they're presented with a room larger than most of them probably thought possible. The far walls can't be seen, the tops of huge support pillars can't be seen above, and all around them are chunks of ancient Giant effigies and mine carts collecting dust. Skeletons are broken across the stone floor, almost as if ripped apart piece by piece.

About 100' ahead, in the darkness, the minecart track splits, one leading down a slight decline, and one inclining steadily (right and left, respectively). Rather than wandering in the darkness of this collosal room, it's advisable for the party to follow one of these tracks to find their way through. Some inspection of the tracks will reveal a switch near to where the tracks meet. Pulling the switch moves a section of the track in front of them from the inclined track to the track declining, off to the right.

At this point, the party should scout ahead to see what the tracks are like. Up the left track they'll find that it levels off rather quickly, and seems to open into a large corridor, unfortunately caved in about 200' farther down. To clear this would not only take a monumental feat of strength, but also more time than the players can spare. Down the right track (no pun intended) they'll find that the tracks move down, then up, then down, then up-- ever increasing in their inclines and declines.

When they search around and take a look at the tracks, a **Wisdom (Perception)** of **DC 15** will uncover a clue for them. Hanging from a rail-spike is a small piece of purple cloth. The party recognizes it as a piece of **Gherhart's** tunic. Further inspection will show there to be tracks in the dust along the mine car rails...

That's right, **the Silver Hook** is ahead of the party, and following the same path they are. Not only that, but they've worked out a way to traverse this gigantic abandoned mine at a breakneck pace-- by riding the rails in a minecart!

With some searching around, the players can find 2 or 3 old iron carts that might be up to the challenge (they are). When they put the cart on the tracks, they're taken aback, as the track begins to glow a bright blue, and leads farther than they can see, whiping and winding, finally dissapearing into a hole in the far wall.

The players can load into the cart (it was made for a high volume, so it's quite large) as long as they can lift it up (strength athletics check of 20). Once inside, it just takes a little push from the last person to jump in, and a **Dexterity Save** of **12** by that character to leap into the moving cart.

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Figure 1.1



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This is where the fun begins.

Refer to the map for directional choices, breaks and jumps in the track, unstable areas, and the location of switches. You'll notice that the following 4 headers are different colors; these colors correspond to the different notes as shown in the map of the mines in Figure 1.1, starting from the bottom of the figure.

Directional Choices

The party will need to lean the cart to the right or left at the junction in order to travel that direction. More than half the party will need to succeed on either a **Dexterity Save or Strength Save of 12** for the cart to go down the desired path. For example, if there were 5 people in a party they would need 3 successes, if there are 4 people, they would still need 3 successes-- more than half the party needs to succeed. If that doesn't happen, roll a die. Any ol' die will do, just randomize the direction of the cart, right or left.

Track Junctions

Normally, these carts would be monitored from the outside, empty, and under normal working order along complete tracks. It was perfectly normal for the designers to locate the switches for the junctions 2 cartlengths away from the junction itself. However, the party is traveling (by now) at a speed unintended by original design. To choose the direction for these Track Junctions, they'll need to make a **Dexterity Save of 18** to hit the switch correctly, before their cart turns, as they pass the switch at breakneck speed. Once again, if they fail, choose the direction randomly (or with your best discretion).

Gaps in the Track

This obstacle is purely for player terror. Don't drop them down the endless pit that sits beneath the collapsed track. If they fail too horribly, make some rolls behind the screen and inform them that Lady Luck is on their side, as they're thrown to the other side of the expanse beneath them. These points have an incline in the track that propels the party's cart across a pit left by previous destruction. Just before the jump, the party needs to heave forward to propel themselves straight onto the next track with a **Dexterity or Strength Save of 16**. Only half of the party needs to succeed for them to make it to the next track.

Falling Rocks

Due to the instability of this temple, and the recent violent activity on the tracks, fissures have appeared in the rock above. **Dexterity or Strengh Saves of 13** will need to be made by more than half the party to be able to dodge the falling rock in the cart.

Obviously there is more that a party can do than use their reflexes or brute force, so if a character comes up with a solution to an obstacle that is outside these parameters, reward their creativity and move the story along-- time is of the essence!

The party eventually finds themselves at the far end of the mine. The blue tracks rush ahead of them, brimming with luminescence and giving them clues to what's ahead the entire time, creating beautiful but distracting patterns as their trajectory varies violently in inclination. Once their cart straightens out and they get their bearings, they're immediately faced with a dead end! This time, only a **Dexterity Save of 15** will allow them to vacate the cart at the right moment to land on stable ground. Otherwise, anyone still in the cart crashing against the wall will take **4d6 (average 14) bludgeoning damage.**

Once they make it to their feet, kiss the ground, and take a look around, they see a faint light in the ceiling above. In front of them, at the foot of their crushed cart, the party notices a giant staircase winding back and forth, leading up toward a bleak ray of sunlight through the impossibly high ceilings.

Once they climb it (**Constitution Check of 12)**, and half an hour's climb) they find themselves on the outside, standing on a rare piece of flat(ish) land. They're due for a rest.

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Above the Mines, Below the Crypt

The climb that ensues after the party escapes the mines is arduous. Since the players aren't yet to the area that requires real searching for this hidden crypt, the navigation is reletively easy. However, steep cliffs punctuated with outjets of jagged stone are made even more dangerous by the recent glacial melt. Wet surfaces and straggling ice in unsuspected footholds spell peril for the adventurers, and they'll need to make constant **Dexterity (Acrobatics) or Strength (Athletics)** checks as they travel.

This section largely relies on you, the Dungeon Master, to survey the table and take note of how much time you've already spent on this adventure. As we stated at the beginning, pacing is integral to the excitement of this story, and the party is still an encounter or two away from their destination. Take a minute, check your watch (do people still wear those?), and decide how much time and attention you want to spend on the journey up the mountainside, itself.

In our experience, accomplishments are always hightened if the path to them was challenging. Spending some time laying the groundwork for the treacherous tone of the climb may be beneficial to the next encounter (an especially dangerous cliffside), and the last time they'll be forced to face these kind of immediate obstacles). If your party consists of very athletic characters, this might be a good time to let them show off a bit and make easy work of a couple natural obstacles. If the party is comprised of mainly cerebral characters, this could be a good time to underscore the danger that they face completing this good deed and return a greater satisfaction when they overcome the climb. It's all up to you, you know your players, their characters, and your own DMing style. Following are some descriptions of particularly interesting natural phenomena that you can pepper into your own narrative of the travel, as well as some encounter ideas if you have the time or inclination to let your players stretch their sword-arms.

If you decide to spend some time on this ascent at the end of Act I, we recommend choosing a terrain description and pairing it with your choice of encounter as described on the following page. The purpose of this section is to convey to the players just what a difficult trip this is, so as long as that's communicated, you're good to move on!

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Encounter Features
"Your foot finds a loose stone on the slope and your weight has sent it careening down the side of the mountain. As you watch it smack larger boulders on its way down, your attention is drawn to your own current situation: the slope above you is now sliding down quickly, having been unseated by the large rocks removed below."
"Jagged black rocks seemingly pierce through the mountainside making your climb no more difficult, but increasing the potential for disastrous outcomes should you slip."
"The wind tears around the porous rocks ahead of you as you ascend. Large holes and good grips make your climb a little easier, but you find your feet getting caught unexpectedly in the degraded stone, causing you to spend extra time and care to not get yourselves stuck."
"As if the last rocky mound wasn't slippery enough, the only path you see before you now is a 20 foot tall wall of smoothed ice. Small streams of melt wash over the surface that you're expected to climb."

+

d4	Encounter Description
1	As the party climbs the rocky mountainside, make a Passive Wisdom (Perception) check for them. If they succeed, not 30 ft away from them is a sleeping Stone Giant. With good Dexterity (Stealth) checks on behalf of the party, or bad Wisdom (Perception) checks on behalf of the Giant, they can avoid the encounter. Keep in mind that Stone Giants' behavior is stranger than normal while they are above ground; read their entry in the Monster Manual to make this encounter more than just a hack and slash, if you like.
2	A team of formidable bandits is waiting for the players among the mountain slabs. They were hired along the way by the Silver Hook to "slow the players down." Once the party does away with the bandits, they can question one, or they find a note from Gherhart in one of the bandits' pouches describing each player and giving a 25 gold bounty for success.
3	2-4 Cyclops sit around a fire and cauldron outside of a large cavern up the mountainside from the players. If the Cyclops spot the players downhill, they each pick up a large torch and separately make their way toward the group. Make it obvious that the party is now being hunted by the Cyclops' group. they can either stand and fight, or try to keep their heads down and stay hidden until the Cyclops lose interest. If they decide to stealth up to the Cyclops for a closer look, they find that in the cavern are 3 unconcious Gnomes, no doubt the reason the cauldron is boiling...
4	On a particularly steep incline, the players might notice large Violet Fungus growing all around them, from every crack and angle you can describe. The party will only be able to discern their true nature by disturbing one; otherwise make them be extraordinarily careful climbing, and upon failure start the combat portion of the encounter.

Along with these colorful descriptions of the difficult terrain, you can introduce an encounter if you like! The Spine of the World is renowned for its danger, and the players couldn't have expected to get too far without the area putting up a fight, right? Combine the top table for environmental encounter features with the encounters themselves below at will!

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Act II
The Thawed Ascent
-or-
"Hooked"

Ice is ice. No matter if it's unseasonably warm, there is a biting chill the closer we get to the peak. Something tells me it isn't the wind, but rather something unnatural and evil in the caverns up ahead. *-Ashemmi's Journal*

By now, your players are sick and tired of climbing these mountains. They've probably stopped to rest once or twice, and are wondering how far behind **Gherhart's** party that's put them. Conveniently enough, they're about to find out. You see, we only needed to create the illusion of urgency. **The Silver Hook** encounters are planned, and designed mostly as agitating conflicts, role playing moments, or plot development-- they're not intended to be a Party vs. Party brawl.

However...

In our travels across Faerûn, and with every different adventuring group we've travelled with, we've realized that you can't always predict the intention and ability of a party that's set its mind to something. If your party doesn't detest **the Silver Hook** group already, they're about to. They may try to murder them. Try to stop them, for the story's sake. Obviously don't make it seem like you're getting in the way of their free will, but if you pepper in circumstance, distraction, and the notion that **Gherhart** just might be better than them, they should buy **the Silver Hook's** escape. Just in case though, we've included their stat blocks anyhow in the appendix.

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The Climb

It's important to describe this next obstacle as unique from the past few. This is the party's last real ascent before they reach their destination, and is it a doozy...

In this scenario, the party is faced with a 150' tall cliff with an alarming amount of icy water pouring over the edge. To their left and right the path is unclimbable, it's a negative incline and slipperier than they'll want to deal with. The cliff in front of them has paths upwards that look like they have good holds and are free from the water stream, though the rapid melt from above is inconsistent in where it falls so that may change.

The good news is that above this cliff, there is near-flat land, and climbing it should begin the real hunt for the crypt's location. The bad news? About halfway up they need to make **Wisdom (Perception)** checks. Successful ones **(DC 14)** will reveal a silhouette leaning over the cliff. Closer inspection or better rolling shows them that this is **Gherhart**. He doesn't look happy.

The DCs and routes of the climb are detailed in figure X.X on the next page. Treat this like the mine cart ride beforehand, ask them at each step which way they'd like to climb or what they'd like to do. They'll most likely have an accomplished spellcaster, or someone that would otherwise make quick work of this climb, and that's why **Gherhart's crew** is pushing boulders over the side of the cliff and attempting to destablize the wall.

If someone flies up, crawls or jumps quickly, or teleports, **Gherhart** has a contingency. After all, this merry band of ruffians isn't your run of the mill handful of NPCs. Rather, they're a formidable competing party-- with their own spellcasters. All **Gherhart** and his goons need to really do here is impede or damage the party, make them extraordinarily mad, and take off ahead. The legend on the Figure 2.1 will dictate the DCs of the saves versus the falling rocks, water gushes, and the damage everything (including falling...) does. Refer to **the Silver Hook's** stat blocks for creative ways to stall the party. We like to have the **Kelvin, the Warlock,** waiting at the top to *Hold Person* anyone that comes over the top, while **Gherhart** pushes them off. Use the distraction of their falling friend to make a break for it into the mountaintop rocks. Since they have a **Ranger, Lesindore,** with them, tracking them has been and will continue to be nearly impossible. Additionally, there are optional feats given to each member of the Silver Hook; if you're interested in using them in combat, they are shown on their stat blocks in the Appendix.

Once they make it up the cliff, the Silver Hook is nowhere to be seen. They can either push onward, or stop to rest and lick their wounds.

Into the Mountaintop Crypt

The mountaintop is a large place to search, with many caves and crevices. Jagged black rocks protrude from under snow and ice, half melted. A **Wisdom (Survival) roll of DC 16** can show the party where it's most likely that a structure would have been built here, and **one of 20** will lead them right to the doorway. Have the players roll a few times if necessary, do some **Intelligence (Investigation) s** if they need to, but let them know they're close. Allow some time for distance between them and **the Silver Hook**, and when you feel you've drawn out the suspense enough, they arrive at their destination...

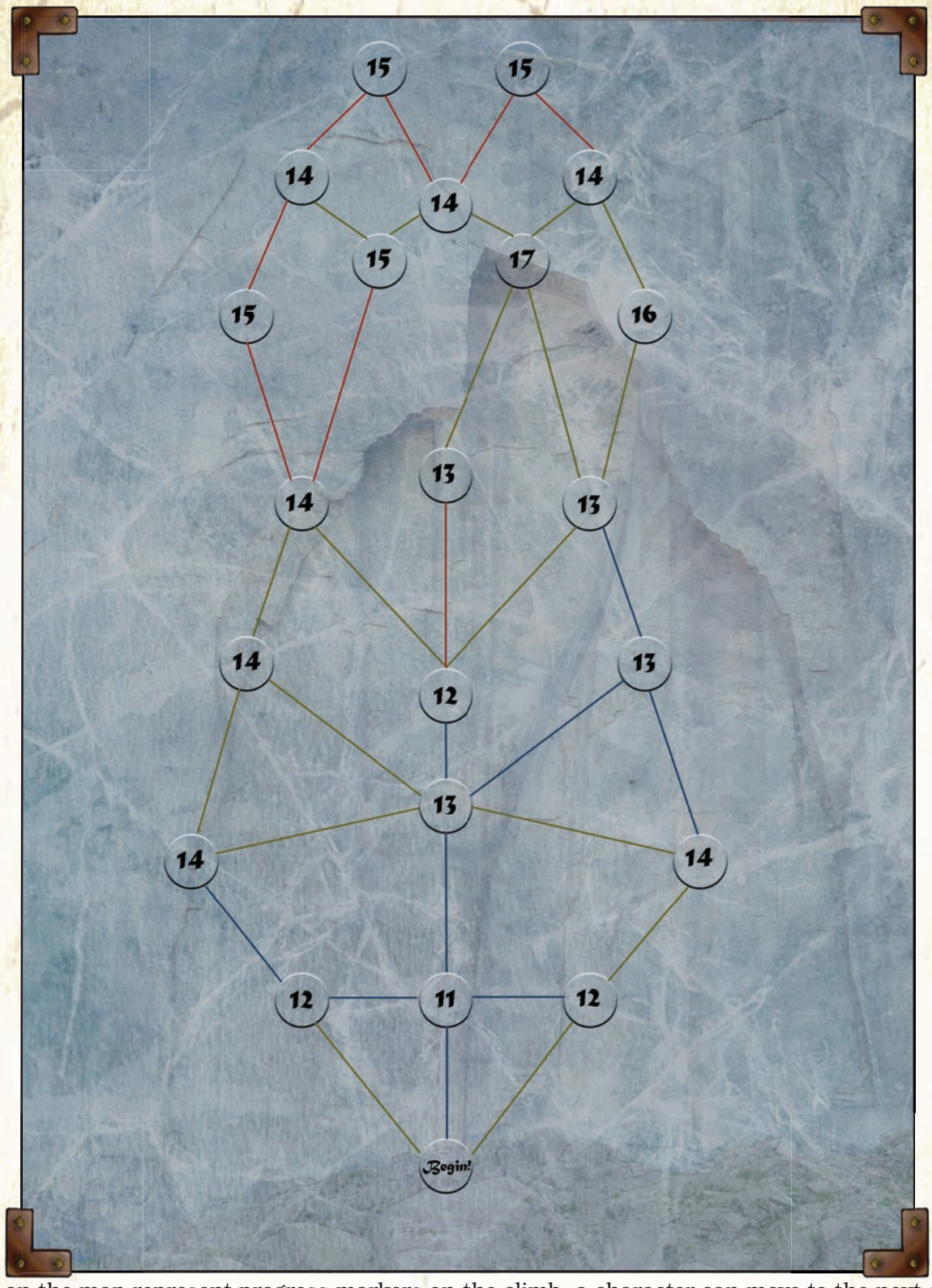
The Ice Caverns

As beautiful as the glistening entrance to the cavern is, the party can't help but feel an overwhelming dread, as though this place was never meant to be seen. A colossal ice sheet has melted and fissured. Rock shows through in thin spots, but the large opening leading into the mountain looks to be lined entirely with ice.

d10	Random Ice Cavern Encounters
1-2	1d12 Zombies (MM pages 315/316)
3-5	1d8 Sabre Tooth Tigers (MM page 336)
6-7	1d6 Phase Spiders (MM page 334)
8	2 Bone Nagas (MM page 233)
9	1d6 Minotaur Skeletons (MM page 273)
10	1d4 Young Remorhazes (MM page 258)

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Figure 2.1



The circles on the map represent progress markers on the climb, a character can move to the next circle every turn. The DC for their climb is on the circle they're climbing to, and the line's color represents the obstacle they'll need to overcome to get there:

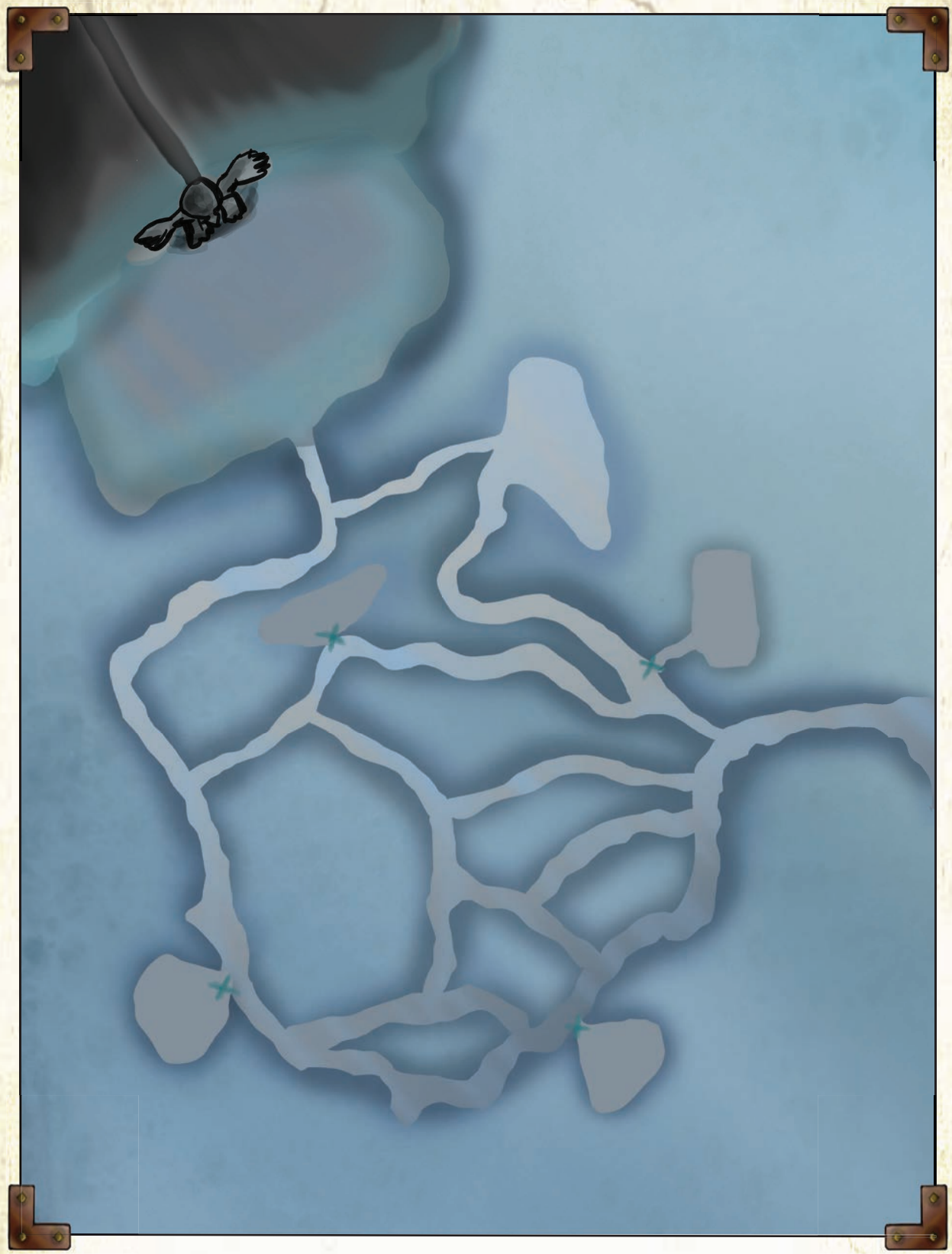
Blue Line- Simple climb, plenty of footholds in the ice. If the player fails the climb check, they may not proceed to the next circle.

Yellow Line- Hardly any footholds, very slippery climb. If the player fails their climb check, they slip and fall.

Red Line- Gherhart's chunks of ice and rocks are falling in this path. If they fail their climb check, they'll need to make a dexterity save (same DC as this step of the climb) or take 2d6 bludgeoning damage, and fall to the circle beneath them.

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Figure 2.2



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Inside, the party will need to navigate caverns made of ice before they reach the rock of the mountain, wherein lies the crypt they've been searching for. Figure 2.2 to the left describes the structure of the caverns, with the player party entering from the right-hand side and their destination in the upper left.

The icy walls of the cavern are smooth and glistening due to the melt, and holes have appeared in the ceiling. The sunlight shines through and refracts brightly against the frozen interior, making it difficult to see clearly or in great detail. Players that have darkvision as a racial trait, or disadvantage in daylight have especially hard times telling what is a pathway and what is a reflection. **Wisdom (Perception)s** made by players with normal vision are still hampered, but that's been worked into the DC rather than giving the players disadvantage.

The map in Figure X.X shows secret entrances to rooms or passageways covered in ice (X marks the spot), DCs to locate these secret entrances are Wisdom (Perception) 16 and to open them, 18 of an applicable skill check appropriate to thaw the ice. It's important to note to the players the flowing streams of water coming down the walls and pooling around their feet, the cracks that show in some of the larger pillar-like iceforms, because this cavern is not necessarily stable. Any sort of violent heat source (*Fireball* and the like) will cause portions of the wall and ceiling to come crashing down around the players, requiring a **Dexterity Save (DC 16)** to avoid damage. Likewise, large crashes against the walls or frozen over doorways is likely to trigger the same reaction, enlarging the cracks and dropping more debris.

The secret rooms contain various basic items that may be useful to the party which you can allocate to the various rooms at your discretion--alternatively, you can also throw them a random encounter inside instead of a reward, Three of the rooms can contain, for instance, **Greater Potions of Healing, bags of 1000 ball bearings** (talk about slippery in conjunction with the ice!), **and/or magical scrolls** which might help them in the dungeon ahead should their party makeup complicate any traps or situations, per your discretion. The fourth secret room, however, is a little different:

Make special note of the "armory" off the main entrance to the caverns (right at the first fork from the entrance), It's basically just a collection of old weapon racks with spears and shortswords, as well as numerous large tower shields, and it will become important in the most crucial moment of the player's excursion. If they find no other secret entrance, or if they gloss over entering it in favor of caution, nudge them that way a bit and make it a little easier. It will be all the more gratifying for the players if they remember this room in Act III, without you calling attention to it.

Once they make it through the twists, turns, and tremors of the ice caverns, they find themselves in the first bit of intentionally carved mountainside. A colossal cavern, which may rival the giant tombs they were in earlier, lies before them. At the opposite end stands a statue 150' tall, its hands stretched palmside to the ceiling. It resembles Atlas, but wears wizard's robes. Its face is the most interesting point, as the ephigy of a Hobgoblin stands before the party in grandiose stature unseen in modern Faerûn.

The Gricks

As the characters approach the statue (there isn't much else to do in the room) have them make **DC 17 Wisdom (Perception)** checks. If the players are successful, among the ice and stone littered around the floor, they spot a corpse. This is their warning that something here isn't right. The body, a female tiefling, is frozen stiff and covered in thick frost. This is (or was), in fact, Lesindore of the Silver Hook! Bite wounds and gashes litter her body, but she seems to have been frozen to death. This must be a natural ritual of some predator in the mountain, to freeze its prey before they devour it.

That brings us to the Hobgoblin statue, again. Arcane runes and Goblin-language text litter the base of the statue. You can allow the players to inspect them, but you should give them a chance to see **(Wisdom (Perception) DC 12)** the large cracks and openings all the way up the statue's torsoe. If they noticed the corpse beforehand, they are able to discern that the predators they learned of are most likely housed in these holes. Up near the top, they can see a hole that's not like the others, which are born of cracks and erosion. No, the one just below the

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figure's neck is purposely carved out, albeit roughly. To reach that passageway, they'll need to bypass the **Polar Gricks** awaiting them in the holes all the way up!

Refer to the **Polar Grick's** stat block as the characters battle them. Introduce them in waves as they climb, and don't be afraid to make a strong showing. Stretch the **Gricks** to their limit to stop the adventurers from reaching the hole, but keep in mind that this encounter is here to take some of their hit points, force a rest, or sap some spellcaster slots. They'll be facing plenty up ahead, but really stretch their combat muscles here. It will prepare them for what's ahead. Killing over half of the **Gricks** will force them to retreat back into their holes; alternatively, if the party climbs higher than the stomatch of the statue, the **Gricks** will consider them to be lost prey and choose to allow them to "flee."

Polar Grick

Medium monstrosity, neutral

Armor Class: 16 (natural armor: Ice Plates)
Hit Points: 27 (6d8)
Speed: 30', climb 30', burrow 20'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	11 (0)	3 (-4)	14 (+2)	5 (-3)

Senses: darkvision 60', passive Perception 12
Damage Vulnerabilities: force
Damage Resistances: bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from non-magical weapons
Damage Immunities: cold
Languages: ---
Challenge: 2

Icy Camouflage. The grick has advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks made to hide among snow and ice.

Burrowing. The grick can burrow through ice or snow as if it were dirt, moving any direction they like, slithering at 20' per round.

Actions

Multiattack. The grick makes one attack with its tentacles. If that attack hits, the grick can make one Beak attack against the same target.

Tentacles. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) slashing damage.

Beak. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage. The target must make a DC 14 Constitution save or take 1d6 cold damage. If a creature is affected by the cold damage 3+ times, they are slowed for 1d4 turns,

Description

This wormlike monstrosity blends in with the ice in the caverns it haunts. When prey comes near, its freezing tentacles unfurl to reveal its hungry, snapping beak. Polar Gricks like to freeze their prey before eating it, even if it hasn't died yet.

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Act III
Secrets Revealed
-or-
The Phylactery in the Library

An hour after we've reached out destination and we've only just come upon the frightful entrance to the crypt that Emory led us to. Gronni all but pleaded for us to turn around, Milli can't eat for her nerves, but Emory and Brendan stoically and unnervingly trudge forward. I don't care what happens here, this is not where I breath my last breath. *-Ashemmi's Journal*

Once the Gricks subside, the players climb into a rubble-strewn passageway about 40' long leading straight into the wall through the gargantuan hobgoblin statue itself...

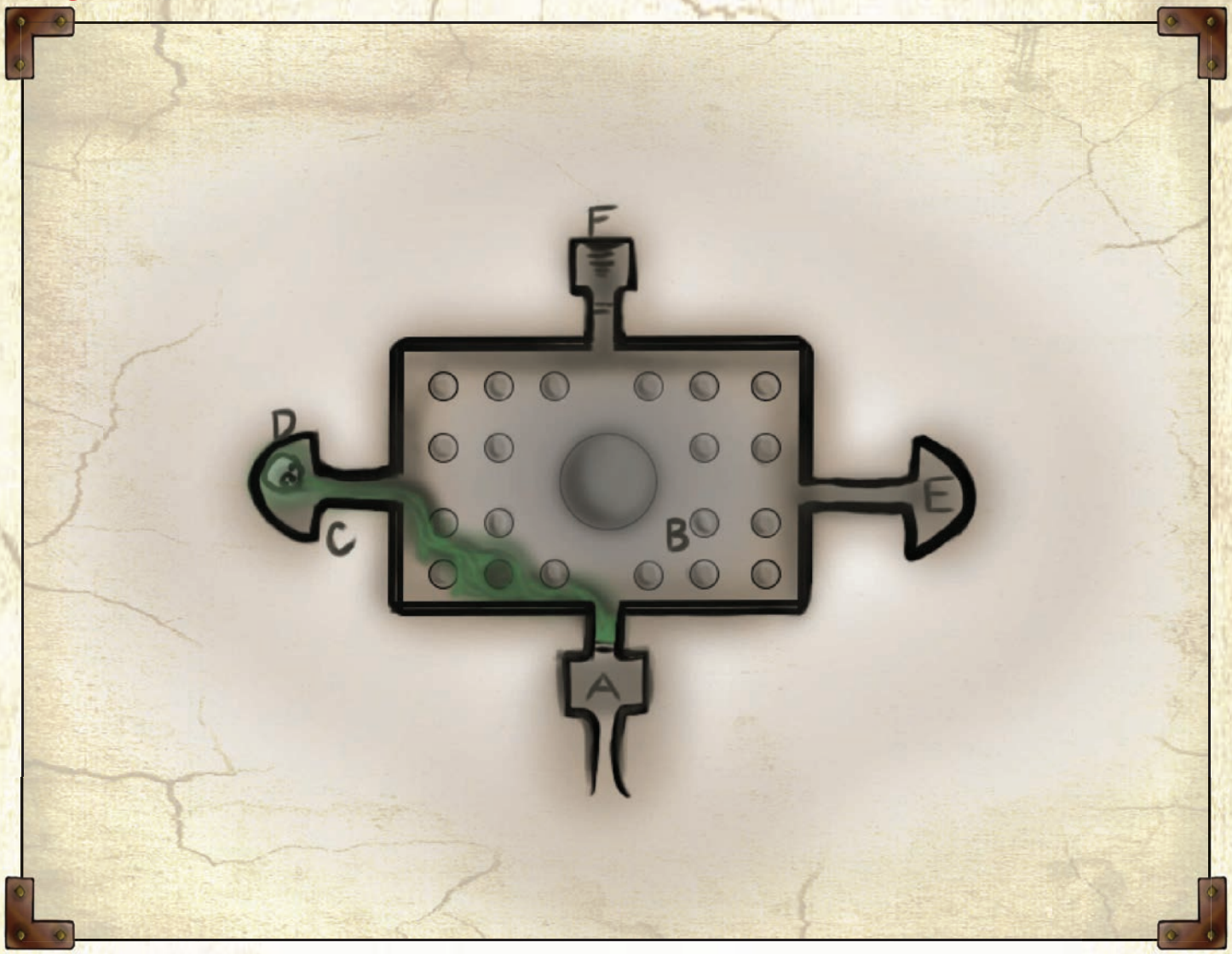
Into the Gullet of Orvanath

At the end of this hallway is a medium-sized doorway, its door busted through. A **Wisdom (Perception) check of 12** or higher sees that the area directly surrounding the door is singed, and the player surmises that Gherhart's party triggered a trap when they forced their way in. They should be on their guard as they enter...

Figure 3.1 on the following page describes the rooms on the first floor of this dangerous place, and each room or area is indicated by a letter. The rooms are described in detail alphabetically (and likely in the order they'll be addressed by the party). Feel free to refer to the random encounter table under the map as you see fit!

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Figure 3.1



d20	Random Stone Giant Crypt Encounters
1-5	1d10 Piercers (MM page 252)
6-8	1d6 Helmed Horrors (MM page 183)
9-11	1d6 Ogre Zombies (MM page 316)
12-14	2d6 Carrion Crawlers (MM page 37)
15-16	1d20 Crawling Claws (MM page 44)
17-18	1d4 Ghosts (MM page 147)
19	1d4 Flesh Golem (MM page 169)
20	1d4 Cloakers (MM page 41)

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A. The Antechamber

This room is originally of stone giant origin, which is made clear by the architectural style and size. The room is hewn from the mountain side, a grand foyer 80' wide and 60' long, its ceilings hang at least 100' above. The massive door at the other end is cracked open, and a large spike sticks out of the hard, rocky floor at an angle which indicates that it came from the wall above, below a burnt-out brazier. Clearly a sprung trap. The air is musty, but surprisingly damp for the cold air of the ice caverns—this heavier air is wafting from the halls beyond, through the cracked door. The party may endure a random encounter here from creatures just seeking the "world" outside their door. On the ground, the party can find a small, poorly drawn map of the mountains leading up to this place, with a large question mark beyond these doors. It was dropped by **Gherhart**, so their party is clearly now as lost as the player party is.

B. The Hall of Pillars

Beyond the door is a short hallway, shorter than the last but still massive, with a staircase leading upward. The stairs are giant-sized, but there are very old planks of wood lined up along the deep, shallow stairs, creating a ramp. They'll hold, but they're in pretty rough shape. These ramps indicate that this area has been used more recently by creatures who weren't giants.

At the top of the stairs, a two-foot wide sewer grate stops the "flow" of something thoroughly disgusting coming from further into the room, wrapping across the floor like a lazy snake to the West. The substance is thick, but extremely slick, and traveling across it behaves as though the *Grease* spell were cast on the floor. It is brown-grey and smells abhorrent, and any who touch it with their skin must succeed a **Constitution Save (DC 12)** or be sickened for ten minutes, rolling a **d10** at the start of each round. A result of **2** or below and the player's entire turn is spent retching.

The rest of the Hall of Pillars is simply gargantuan; the wide, high ceiling supported by two dozen small pillars of stone, with a massive pillar 80' wide in the center. Coming within 60' of the central pillar will trigger an encounter with **6 Shadows** (*Monster Manual* page 269).

Across from the entrance, the far side contains a door that is magically locked and will not open unless the password is spoken. There is rubble at the base of the hallway, however, blocking it off, but a human-sized scaffolding can be used to access it.

This scaffolding scrawls along the wall, about 20' up, leading over to the wall near the hallway to the East of the Hall of Pillars, where it can be accessed from the Infirmary hallway. Fresh tracks in the area by the magically locked door prove that **the Silver Hook** made it through, and a faint green glow emanates from the crack under it. There are some slimy tracks indicating that **Gherhart's party** must have at least gone in that direction at some point, toward the West and the origin of the disgusting slime. The door "speaks" to any who approach it to request the password, doing so in the listener's mind as through the *Message* spell, irrespective of language comprehension.

C. The Greased Hallway

The disgusting, slimy grease on the floor in the Hall of Pillars completely floods the floor of this hallway, which is inclined upward, so the grease is clearly flowing down it. At the top, the giant doors are open and have been for what must be ages. All along the hallway, however, are torch-holders at human-eye level, indicating that a more appropriately-sized creature or creatures has utilized this place more recently. Here, the party will encounter **2 Grey Oozes and a Black Pudding** (*Monster Manual* pages 243 and 241, respectively) As the party travels up the incline, another tower shield like the ones in the ice cavern should slide past them, downhill, not too slowly but not too quickly. Be sure to describe this memorably to the players as it is the answer to their final escape.

D. The Armory

Ah, the source of the foul, brown-grey slime pervading the senses in this dungeon: a rotting hill giant head, wearing a helmet made of cobbled-together suits of armor. Its decomposition slowed by the cold air, it oozes nevertheless as **5 Rust Monsters** (*Monster Manual* page 262) scuffle along the armor that makes up its helmet. A cave-in here has left a heap of rubble right by the severed monstrosity, and a small stream of water flows slowly down the wall, across the rubble, and onto the head, hastening

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its putrification. Drinking a mouthful of water downstream of the head will inflict **1d8 necrotic damage** (please e-mail us if your players are dumb enough to do this). Along the wall are several more tower shields like the one the party saw sliding down the grease in the hallway. Among swords, pikes, and shields that appear to be centuries old, there are some scrolls of notes strewn across a desk. Notably, the rotting hill giant head is a relatively more recent addition to this room, but nothing else here seems to have been disturbed upon its arrival, save for the Rust Monsters that had been happily chewing away on suits of armor and weaponry prior to its arrival. The scrolls are all notes written in Goblin, in the Dwarvish script used by the language centuries ago. Any who can speak both languages, or if the players want to take time combining language abilities, can discover that these are construction notes about making this stone giant crypt more accessible for hobgoblins; however, also of note are a few faded words mentioning "rune circles." Regardless, one short phrase is scrawled across the top of one of the notes in the Common language: "the Dormitory."

Make it overly clear to the party that one Goblin word appears on several documents over and over again: "**Orvanath**." Volume I of a book fascinatingly named *Concerning the Transliteration of Dwarvish and Common Scripts* is on the table as well, recently moved here, and is of no use—it isn't the half the party needs to read any of this.

E. The Dormitory

On the eastern side of the Hall of Pillars is another inclined hallway, a mirror image to the greased hallway to the west, the top of which can be reached without incident or with a random encounter depending upon your own judgment of your session's pacing. The stone giant doors here are still closed, but a normal-sized door has been carved into the base. Inside is what can only be described as the remains of a centuries old dormitory, with beds strewn about and old, tattered, moth-eaten sheets hanging between various rows. Among the ruins are old medical supplies which are no longer of use, as well as bowls, plates, cups, and silverware.

Among the various books, however, is Volume II of *Concerning the Transliteration of Dwarvish and Common Scripts*, which the party can use to decipher the "**Orvanath**" text written on the notes back across the Hall of Pillars in the Armory. If the party discovers this volume of the book before the one in the Armory, ensure the party is aware that there are greasy footprints here as well, indicating the presence of **the Silver Hook**. Upon disturbing this book, the hanging sheets stir and the party is approached by **6 Scarecrows** (*Monster Manual* page 268).

F. The Vestibule

By this point, it should come as no surprise that the password for the door at the northern end of the Hall of Pillars is "Orvanath," and speaking the word aloud nearby causes them to open. Once the party passes throgh, they find themselves at the bottom of another steep incline. It's a tough walk up, **Strength (Athletics) or Dexterity (Acrobatics) checks of DC 15** can be made here to make the climb easier, or else they need to "walk" up a 70 degree slope with perilously loose stones on the floor. The walls are carved with ominous Hobgoblin death omens and warnings to turn back. At the top of the slope is a room, 30'x30', expertly carved and adorned with old magic runes, some runes emitting a soft green glow that permeates the area. A staircase lies behind a door ajar directly opposite the entrance. The stone door is covered in dust and cobwebs, except for one spot 4' off of the ground where there are 3 sets of hand prints: **Gherhart's party** has moved through here already as well. A **Wisdom (Perception) check of DC 12** can spot those prints, as well as the copious amount of blood that's been tracked through the room. It looks as though **Gherhart**, or one of his party members, is badly wounded. The blood is about an hour old if one of the characters wants to make a **Wisdom (Survival) or (Medicine) check of DC 18**. Otherwise the party just knows that they've been here recently. Up the human-sized stairs are...

The Small Sancta

The humanoid-sized onyx staircase leads the party upwards, about 60', and lets out into a hallway, only 10' wide. There are 2 doors on either side of the corridor, and at the end a large stone slab is ajar (obviously a previously opened secret door). All of the rooms the hallway doors lead to are 20'x20' and host myriad ancient surgical tools, as well as dilapidated spellbooks. In the center of each room is a large stone alter, blood stained over many years, with chains lying over it.

A player with a **Wisdom (Perception) check**

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of DC 14 can hear gargled breaths from the farthest room on the right before they enter. If they don't notice and simply enter the open doorway, they're greeted with a surprise *Magic Missile* from a wand held by a mortally wounded **Kelvin, the Silver Hook's Warlock**! He lies, slumped against the back wall, on death's door. He's simply shooting at any movement, hoping to rest long enough without bleeding out from his wounds to get himself to safety. However, this is one of Gherhart's men-- the very same who have tried to outmaneuver and apply dirty tactics to their competition with the players. There is every chance that an attack on the party would push them to end his life quickly, which is just fine. If they happen to hear him breathing and approach cautiously, he doesn't see them in time to get the missile off, and they can attempt to question him.

Kelvin is pretty out of it, having lost a lot of blood from his stomach wound. The party can choose to heal him, and if they do, he'll accompany them without any conflict of loyalties. He's simply wanting to survive this ordeal, and is pretty peeved at **Gherhart** for leading them in here so unprepared. The party has every reason not to trust him, or heal him, and they shouldn't be pressured to do so. In fact, if you dont' want him tagging along with them, you can simply have him give the information needed and die. We all know you can only do so much to stop players from getting what they want though, so don't fight too hard, regardless.

If questioned, **Kelvin** will spit the following through bulging bruises and bloodied speech:

> **"...Have to leave... It's not what they... before he gets *COUGH COUGH*
> Found this..."**

Kelvin's arm uncurls from around him and onto the floor falls a very old spellbook, which dramatically falls open to a bookmarked page containing the Lichdom Spell.

> **"...Where he... keeps..."**

If he's questioned about his party, he just names the members but then falls back to what he was saying. Otherwise, he dies after he says the words "*Where he keeps.*"

If the party heals him, or resurects him somehow, he'll divulge the secret-- This is the resting place of a Lich's phylactery! He urges the party to leave with him, and they're free to do so after hearing this news. Who knows if the Lich is here, or if he isn't, when he'll return! Try to get them to carry on to fulfill their promise to the stricken families, after all there really is no Lich here, but it provides a great sense of dread to hang over the party, and incentivizes them to finish what they're doing quickly.

Once they resolve what they have to with **Kelvin**, they can move through the hallway and past what was once a secret passageway. Behind the door is another staircase made of onyx, this one very clean and well-kept, except for the blood trail up the entire 2 flights.

The Giants' Sanctum

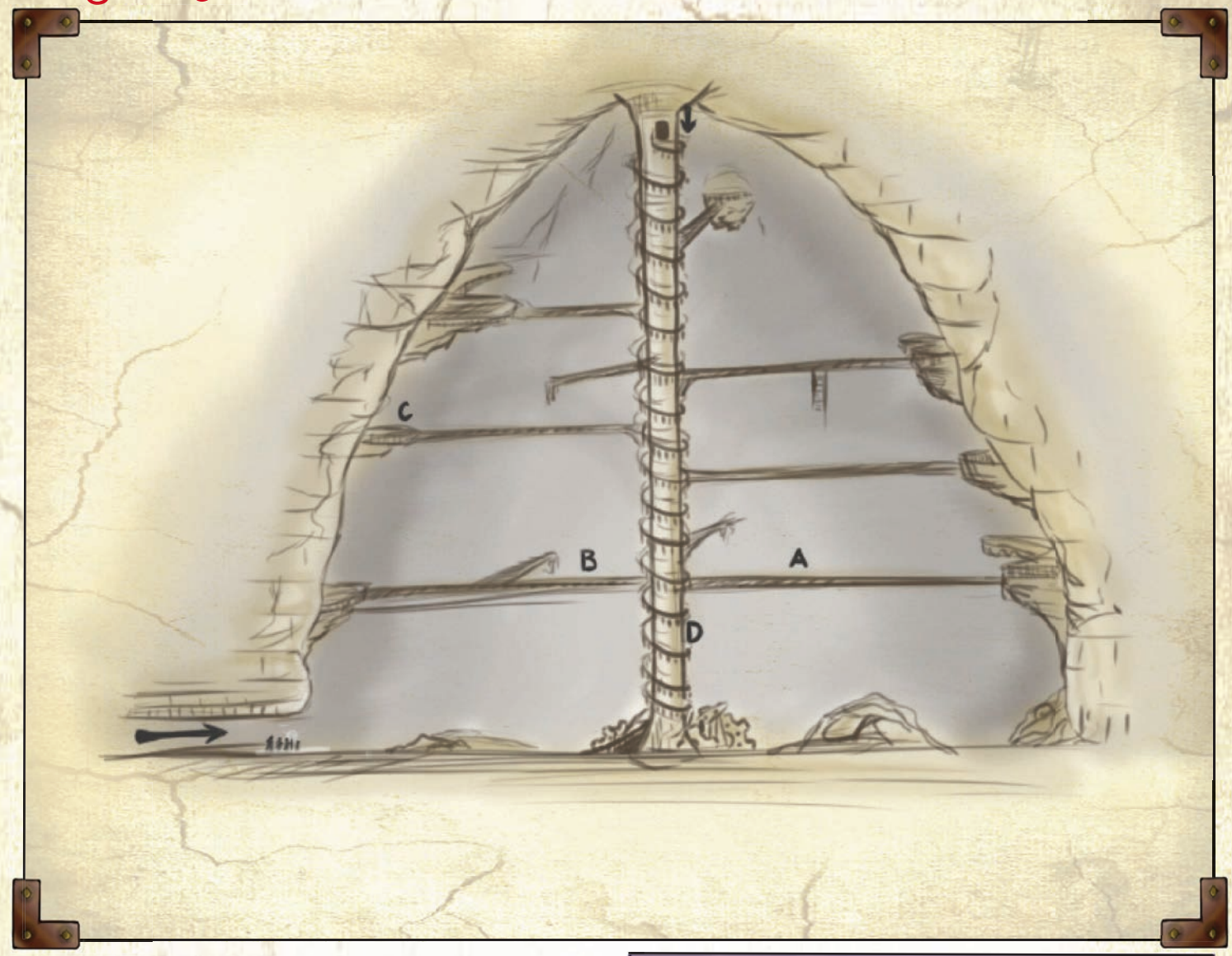
The stairway opens into a colossal room, bringing the party back to the ancient architecture of the Stone Giants. The ceiling is domed and the walls round. Almost a perfect circle, this space is over 200' in diameter, with a 40' diameter column running from the center of the floor to the peak of the cieling, 350' above. Around it winds a metal staircase, precariously attached to the column, and spouting metal bridges every 20' that extend to the permimeter of the walls. There are old rusted gears and mechanisms at the bottom of the collumn, and an **Intelligence (Arcana) check of DC 16** will tell the player that this used to be a giant planar model, hundreds of years ago. Its parts have been salvaged and what's left is broken. The party, because of the room size, can only see so far in the pitch darkness, so many of these observations will be made in the heat of battle.

You see, above the party lies what they've been seeking. Once they get within 50' of the center column and its staircase, **Brugor, Gherhart's Dwarven Rogue**, drops suddenly from above, and thuds harshly against the ground in front of them. There are wounds all over him, made from blades and a dagger, as well as 2 crossbow bolts sticking out from his back. Blood seeps into the dusty stone in front of the party as 4 distant cackles erupt from above.

Eratic sounds of boots on metal echo through

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Figure 3.2



the chamber, only a **Wisdom (Perception) (DC 20)** based on hearing will divulge the locations of the enemies above (shown on the map). Otherwise, and you may bar them from knowing their location if you'd like to play out this scene to its maximum dramatic flair, they simply hear scurrying and laughing from above. Once you've scared them enough, or they've made their way within 15' of the center staircase, one of the **Wights'** voices bounces off the room's walls with a greeting:

"Well, well, well...TWO groups of ne'er-do-wells enter our halls today, what luck, with the past two centuries being SO BLOODY DULL."

Other shriekish voices exclaim and cackle in response to this gruff baritone:

"I'm afraid that if you don't turn back, you'll end up like your portly friend over there."

A crossbow bolt pierces the body of Brugor from up above. Give the party the choice to try to determine the location from which the bolt originated. Have them make a couple Perception or Insight rolls, or let them get creative with how they'd be able to measure the trajectory-- this will give you time to monologue.

"I can't, for the unlife of me, figure out how we're so fortunate, nobody ever stumbles into here. Our blades haven't drunk this much in lifetimes..."

The party, if they thought to do so, can make out a slight shadow (**Wight B** on the map, Figure 3.2), and can maneuver themselves strategically with that knowledge before the battle starts, while listening to

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the voices above.

Another **Wight** chimes in, addressing the first:

"Say, Emory, you don't think it's that time again? A whole cycle come and gone?"

The first **Wight, Emory**, exclaims:

"OH, YOU'RE MOST CERTAINLY CORRECT! And to think, that cavern will stay exposed for another 2 or 3 moons... Just think of all the thieves that will come to raid the Master..."

The **Wights** all make slurping sounds, mimicking eating flesh as best they can, and laughing.

At this point, the party should know whom they're speaking with-- it's the forsaken, perished party of the **Bright Banner Brandished! Orvanath**, once he killed them, turned them into **Wights** designated to protect his phylactery, which the **Wights** will divulge happily in conversation. As soon as they do though, 2 of them leap to the floor in an attempt to surprise the party--- the battle begins!

Refer to the map ahead as well as the individual **Wight** stat blocks in the Appendix for names, placements, and abilties.

The Hidden Basement

After the harrowing fight with the Undead **Bright Banner Brandished**, the party can search the gigantic room. At the very top of the column is a doorway, opened, with a trail of blood running all the way to it. Behind it is a stairway that goes down immediately, and spirals tightly. This travels stories, until the characters think that there can be no more. At the bottom, they find the walls around them to be coarse and broken in places, obviously carved by different means than the rest of the dungeon they've been in.

As the stairway levels out, they can hear scuffling from a large room ahead. Inside is a 150'x300' room with 4 giant sarcophagi inbetween 6 earthen columns forming an aisle across the room to a large adamantine double door. In the center of the room, shuffling towards the door as fast as his injured body will allow, is **Gherhart**. He carries a feeble torch and a **Wisdom (Perception) of DC 12** can hear the soft echoes of him mumbling madly to himself.

The party can do what they wish with him, he's gone mad from the fight with the Wights, seeing his friends slaughtered along the way, and learning the truth about where they are and what might return at any second. When the party approaches to talk, he whips around and points a heavy crossbow in their direction. He's sweating, bleeding, and babbling:

"Orvanath! A Lich... a lich is... here? No, he would have come for us by now... "

He doesn't fire, but is obviously not lucid and rather unpredictable. The party can question him, but he repeats most of what he's been babbling.

"I left them... they failed me. I was supposed to save... but now... gotta find a way out, gotta run. It's here though, I bet it's here...No hope. No hope..."

The party can either put him out of his misery, heal him, or leave him alone. Unfortunately, his madness isn't magical, **Gherhart** has indeed snapped, so there's only so much they can do. If you want to play this encounter to the brink of its dramatic license, when the party approaches **Gherhart** after hearing his rambling in full, he can use his final action to attack the party, or end his own life with his crossbow, repeating "*no hope... no hope... Orvanath will come for his...*" beforehand. We understand that can be a little dark, but the party is in the deepest part of the home of a great Lich's phylactery... it's bound to get a little dark. Keep the tone to what your players appreciate though!

Inside the Giant sarcophagi are giant skeletons, but it would take a lot of time and great feats of strength to lift the ornately decorated lids. If **Orvanath** were here, you can tell the players, he might be able to release them and control them, but with him absent they're probably harmless. An **Intelligence (Arcana) of DC 15** can identify trigger runes on the bases of the sarcophogi though, and

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if this is indeed the hiding place of Orvanath's phylactery, it's likely that they'll go off when it's removed or destroyed. They can't be certain though without inspecting the trigger's origin.

Once **Gherhart** has been neutralized, the party can approach the large Adamantine double doors at the end of the room. It's quite obviously magically locked (*Dispel*, or **DC 18 Thieves' Tools**), physically locked (**DC 15 Thieves' Tools or DC 20 Strength check**), and magically trapped (**DC 18, make it hurt). Orvanath** does not want anyone to enter this room, if the preceding obstacles didn't make that evident enough.

Orvanath's Library

As soon as the seal is broken on the doors, a strong puff of stale air mixed with the scent of old parchment smacks the players in the face. The room inside begins to come to light. Torches along the walls and braziers placed around the room instantly light aflame, as well as a fireplace imbedded in the far wall. Through the doors is a magnificent room (100'x100'x50'), double-floored and housing thousands of books and scrolls. As soon as the party enters, torches light along the walls revealing staircases and built-in bookcases, as well as 5 doors. 2 doors are on the first floor of the room, and 3 can be accessed by staircases leading to the wrapping balcony. Everything is made of stone and the room, with the doors closed, is airtight. Each doorway opens to a hallway 20' long, torchlit, and leading to a 30'x30' room. Every room is square, and lined with boxes, varying in size, shape, and makeup. There are a great many boxes, meant to distract the party from the actual phylactery in the library.

Orvanath's phylactery is, in fact, a metal bust of himself, in life. There are 2 of them, both are acting as banister heads for the staircase directly ahead of the entrance. All of the books, statues, boxes, tapestries-- all decoys. If they remove the phylactery from its banister the entire room jolts violently and quakes every 5 seconds while it's off its post. If destroyed, it will let out a screech, the stone on the face will melt away and reveal its remnants to be a wire skeleton with pieces of parchment inside, covered in runes. Those turn into dust and wisp into the air, emmiting a strong auditory illusion, the voice of **Orvanath** himself!

> **"Sssssoo..... my phylactery is no more-- NO MATTER! You'll not survive to duel with the likes of me, the chosen of my kind, the MASTER OF THE IMMORTAL. I condemn you to your cold, rocky graves. May you writhe for days before taking your final breath beneath the stone-- hahahHAHHAHAHAAHAH!"**

With that, the room starts to come down around the players!

DUNGEON MASTER NOTE

If the players choose not to destroy the phylactery, but rather take it with them, the Lich will be able to scrye on them to retrieve it. If the party returns the phylactery to its post, the siezing crypt calms and they're able to leave via the door they came through (but what fun is that?).

The Escape

If the party destroys or kidnaps the phylactery, the crypt trembles and quakes violently. As they exit the Library, they're faced with 4 raised **Giant Skeletons** wearing giant armor and weilding ancient longswords, emerged from their sarcophagi. The party can confront them, but surely by now **Orvanath** is alerted to the theft and/or destruction, so time is of the essence. If they do fight the **Giant Skeletons**, they'll need to dodge the falling ice and stalactites (**Dexterity Saves of 13** every round they're in the room), and may find themselves unmatched...or they can use those to their advantage, leading the giant skeletons under large stalactites and causing them to plummet on their heads. Either way, the party has to duck the giant swords making waste of the columns holding up the room, and dodge falling rock long enough to make it back to the first floor. Monsters in the dungeon have evacuated, but the instability from the basement has caused the entire crypt to begin imploding under the weight of the mountainside. As the party runs through the dungeon floor, feel free to make more of a show of it than it is. Ask for random saves to dodge rock, untripped-traps, and describe their harrowing run backwards through the dungeon. It should always feel as though the space they just left is safe no more: that they're on the cusp of the wave of

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destruction!

Once they get out of the dungeon and down the hobgoblin statue in the Ice Caverns (that they now notice is an effagy of **Orvanath**, himself) things get a little more difficult.

Making it out of the ice caverns is both a feat of **Dexterity** (the floor is practically frozen solid, **DC 10 Saves** each round to not slip if they're running) and memory (ask them "left, right, or straight" hurriedly to promote urgency). Portions of the cavern are coming down around them. Near the entrance they've just come through, the players need to make **Dexterity Saves (DC 15)** to avoid the falling debris--as well as the floor beginning to crack and fall under their feet. Pepper these in where you feel it fits the pace of their escape.

When your players near the finality of their escape from the ice caverns, a **Wisdom (Perception) of 15** will let them see that most of the first part of the cavern is collapsed, and sliding down the mountainside.

At this point, lean in close to your players. Level with them. Say something like "*Look, you guys can handle this how you want, but it's going to be hard for anyone unable to fly to make it down this mountainside to solid ground. Is there anything that you can think to do to ensure your safety?*"

Those players with adventurous souls like our own might remember the armory with the tower shields, just up ahead. Poke your players in this direction, without flat out telling them what to do. If they don't come up with it on their own, a **Wisdom (Insight) of DC 12** can put the tower shields and the crumbling mountainside together... they can try to sled down ahead of the avalanche coming!

Once they get their shields and the caverns start to come down around them, they leap out the front corridor into the chaos streaming down the mountainside! Have them make one roll (any applicable stat they can justify to you) and then describe their harrowing escape down the slope. They've achieved all their goals and have earned a bit of heroic flair without too much effort.

The avalanche subsides down the mountain just before they hit a spot of reletively flat ground with sparse trees poking up. They can stop themselves, and watch the crumbling destruction they caused above them, and know they delt a blow to an incredibly evil force. A rest is in order before they return to Mirabar, don't you think?

Epilogue

As the party makes it down the mountainside, they can see the fires of the Mines of Mirabar. The group of affected families, **the Highdales and Rightsfelds**, have migrated away from Mirabar closer to the mines in anticipation of their heroes' return, and seem to be celebrating!

The players can choose which NPC they approach to collect their reward and confirm their return, but they're swarmed with healing members of the families no matter whom they approach. Thanks and hugs are thrust upon them (no sickness or nauseous DCs needed), until the crowd parts for the families' elders to approach.

The people around them are noticably healthier, their sores receding by the second. There is a smile on every face, even grumpy **Willem Rightsfeld. Emory** congratulates the party bombastically, slapping them on the shoulder and picking up the smaller ones, gleefully screaming at the top of his lungs. His wife, **Petra**, weeps while she embraces every member of the party, her skin warm for the first time in months, while her brother **Daniel** gives an approving nod.

Larissa approaches with **Margan** in tow, and bestows warm gratitudes on the party, as well as their reward.

"For generations our kin have suffered the cold embrace of this curse, and your warm hearts have lifted it from our families' futures. There is no way to repay you for what you've risked, and what you've brought us. The sun shines on the Highdales and Rightsfelds for the first time in centuries, and it's all because of your bravery. Take these, please, as but the smallest token of what is our...my unending debt. Then, if you please, join us for the first feast these people have ever known!"

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Larissa presents the party with **1000 platinum bars** resting in a chest, and specially engraved **Highdale Daggers (+1 to hit)**.

As the crowd dissapates and festivities are beginning to be set up, **Emory** approaches the party with a redwood box.

"I know that you've been rewarded, and you're probably eager to fill yourselves with celebration, but I want to express my personal thanks... you see, if not for you... my wife..."

Emory begins to tear up, but puffs his chest and proceeds.

"Anyway, take these. I found them in the remnants of the first Emory's belongings, it seems as though he had them cast just before they went on their deadly excursion. If anybody has proven themselves worthy of brandishing these... well, it's you folks."

Emory opens the box on bended knee, showing the players gold broaches meant to be cloak fasteners. They have pressed in them, exquisetly, the **Bright Banner Brandished** symbol. **Emory** continues:

"Now that our family is healed, we'll most likely spread across the Sword Coast, free to travel whatever path we see fit. If you ever come across a Hightdale or Rightsfeld, present them with this broach, and they will do for you anything you need. You have my eternal thanks. As well as my wife's."

These **broaches**, when worn, give a **+1 to Constitution**, an allow the character to act as though they have the **Rustic Hospitality feature of the Folk Hero Background** whenever they meet a member of either family in the future.

Congratulations! Your players have saved the lives of countless individuals and escaped certain death in a plume of snow and rock-- how exciting!

What comes next, you ask? Well, only time will tell. There will be a supplement to this adventure eventually, but for now let your imagination run wild! Will Orvanath come after the party for revenge? Will he hide long enough to create a new phylactery? What other secrets has this warming period uncovered that the players could explore? It's up to you for now!

Until our next installment, we bid you farewell and wish you luck in your adventures. We're the Halfling Bard Brothers-- keep a keen eye out for more of our tales!

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Appendix
NPCs and Encounter Stat Blocks

Larissa Highdale

Medium humanoid (Illuskan human), lawful good

Armor Class: 17 (breastplate, shield)
Hit Points: 28 (4d10 + 8)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)	10 (0)	14 (+2)	18 (+4)

Skills: Persuasion + 4, Insight +2
Senses: passive Perception 12
Languages: Common, Dwarvish

Actions

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8+2) slashing damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Heavy Crossbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, range 100'/400', one target. Hit: 5 (1d10) piercing damage. Larissa carries fifteen crossbow bolts.

Roleplaying Information

A charismatic leader in spite of her situation, Larissa has made curing her late husband's family her quest and is as close to the rest of them as blood, if not closer.

Ideal: "With enough social presence, anyone can champion a cause with the help of others."
Bond: "My family is the most important thing to me and I would do anything to protect them."
Flaw: "I'm a little too eager to investigate new solutions to the family problems."

Margan Eisenheart

Medium humanoid (shield dwarf), lawful good

Armor Class: 18 (breastplate, shield)
Hit Points: 24 (3d10 + 9)
Speed: 25'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	15 (+2)	13 (+1)

Skills: Insight +3, Perception +3
Damage Resistances: poison
Senses: darkvision 60', passive Perception 12
Languages: Common, Dwarvish

Dwarven Resilience. Margan has advantage on saving throws against poison.

Actions

Warhammer. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8+2) bludgeoning damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) bludgeoning damage if used with two hands.

Rallying Shout. Twice per day, Margan can rally his allies to arms, giving as many allies as he chooses within 30' a +2 to all attacks, ability checks, and saving throws for 10 minutes.

Roleplaying Information

Margan has served House Highdale since he was a child, having followed in his ancestors' footsteps as their steward. He cares greatly for the family.

Ideal: "A little cunning goes a long way when trying to solve a problem."
Bond: "I serve House Highdale and, by extension, the Rightsfelds, in an effort to save them all from their fate."
Flaw: "I hide it well, but I'm desperately in love with Larissa Highdale."

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Daniel Highdale

Medium humanoid (Illuskan human), neutral good

Armor Class: 12 (padded armor)
Hit Points: 10 (3d8 - 3)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	12 (+1)	9 (-1)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	15 (+2)

Skills: Persuasion +2, Perception +3
Damage Vulnerability: necrotic
Senses: passive Perception 14
Languages: Common, Elvish

Cursed Aura. Any who touch Daniel must make a DC 15 Constitution saving throw, or become sickened, causing them to have disadvantage on all checks for 10 minutes. The sickened party must roll a d6 before any action, and must take no action if the result is 1 or 2 due to being nauseous.

Actions

Unarmed Strike. 1 bludgeoning damage

Roleplaying Information

Beloved nephew of Larissa, he and his sister Petra are the children of her late brother-in-law, and serve as children in her eyes. Daniel suffers horribly from the curse, but Petra has been helping greatly. He is optimistic.

Ideal: "Keeping in good spirits can alleviate the stresses of any challenge."
Bond: "I owe my sister Petra everything for taking care of me and would do anything to help her if I had the ability."
Flaw: "I can't stand my brother-in-law, the head of House Rightsfeld, Emory."

Petra Rightsfeld

Medium humanoid (Illuskan human), neutral good

Armor Class: 12 (padded armor)
Hit Points: 13 (3d8)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	12 (+1)	10 (0)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	15 (+2)

Skills: Investigate +4, Medicine +4
Damage Vulnerability: necrotic
Senses: passive Perception 14
Languages: Common, Elvish

Nascent Cursed Aura. Any who touch Petra must make a DC 5 Constitution saving throw, or become sickened, causing them to have disadvantage on all checks for 10 minutes. The sickened party must roll a d6 before any action, and must take no action if the result is 1 or 2 due to being nauseous.

Actions

Unarmed Strike. 1 bludgeoning damage

Roleplaying Information

Petra Rightsfeld was born the younger sister of Daniel Highdale, and married Emory Rightsfeld II in a politically-motivated union. She is dedicated to saving her brother foremost, but Emory blames her exposure to Daniel for the appearance of her newly cursed, necrotic tissue.

Ideal: "Family first, duty second."
Bond: "I love my husband Emory, but my emotional attentions are engaged with my brother's health."
Flaw: "My own health is of secondary concern."

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Emory Rightsfeld II

Medium humanoid (Illuskan human), neutral good

Armor Class: 17 (breastplate, shield)
Hit Points: 47 (5d10 + 20)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	13 (+1)	19 (+4)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)

Skills: Persuasion +2, Intimidate +4
Damage Vulnerability: necrotic
Senses: passive Perception 12
Languages: Common

Weakened Cursed Aura. Any who touch Emory must make a DC 10 Constitution saving throw, or become nauseous for 10 minutes. A nauseous party must roll a d10 before each action, and takes no action on a result of 1.

Actions

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d8+4) slashing damage, or 9 (1d10 + 4) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Roleplaying Information

Emory gave himself the suffix "II" himself, when he embarked upon his quest to seek a cure for from the curse, seeking to bolster the relation to his Bright Banner Brandished heritage. He's good at heart, but kind of a jerk.

Ideal: "Taking care of oneself and one's own are the most important things in life."
Bond: "Protecting and curing my wife, Petra, is of tantamount importance."
Flaw: "Any idea could be a good idea as long as it might help my loved ones."

Willem Rightsfeld

Medium humanoid (Illuskan human), neutral good

Armor Class: 15 (breastplate)
Hit Points: 47 (5d10 + 20)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	10 (0)

Skills: Perception+2, Stealth +2
Senses: passive Perception 12
Languages: Common

Actions

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8+3) slashing damage, or 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Extra Attack. Willem may attack a second time during his turn.

Roleplaying Information

Willem is reluctant of his cousin Emory's cause, and is a hopeless pessimist. He lost his loved ones to the curse and is only concerned with his own well-being.

Ideal: "No one else will take care of me, I must take care of myself."
Bond: "I want to go protect my home more than anything right now."
Flaw: "Duty is the only thing keeping me here with my extended family, and it is wearing thin..."

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Gherhart Pine

Medium humanoid (Damaran human), chaotic neutral

Armor Class: 15 (breastplate)
Hit Points: 64 (6d10 + 34)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	13 (+1)	18 (+4)	11 (0)	13 (+1)	11 (0)

Skills: Athletics +5, Survival +4
Senses: passive Perception 11
Languages: Common, Elvish

Optional Feat: Dual Wielder. Gherhart's AC increases by 1 and he can draw or stow his weapons simultaneously as though they were one weapon.

Actions

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack, Two-Weapon Fighting:* +5 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit*: 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage, attacks twice.

Second Wind: Once per day, Gherhart can use a bonus action on his turn to regain hit points equal to 1d10+6 (11 on average).

Roleplaying Information

The young, arrogant leader of the Silver Hook adventuring company, Gherhart's rise to fame, glory, and riches can be quelled by none.

Ideal: "The self-made man is the purest form of man."
Bond: "I'm narcissistically attached to myself, obviously."
Flaw: "My lust for notoriety will prevent my senses from prevailing in the face of potential reward."



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Kelvin Jarrus

Medium humanoid (Illuskan human), chaotic neutral

Armor Class: 15 (studded leather)
Hit Points: 33 (6d8 + 6)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (0)	17 (+3)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)



Skills: Persuasion +6, Perception +4
Senses: passive Perception 14
Languages: Common, Sylvan, Celestial

Optional Feat: Spell Sniper. Kelvin's *Eldritch Blast* range is increased to 600' and ignores half and three-quarters cover. He also gains the *Chilled Touch* cantrip, with its range doubled as well.

Actions

Light Hammer. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit*: 2 (1d4) bludgeoning damage,

Eldritch Blast. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +6 to hit), range 300', up to two targets. *Hit:* 5 (1d10) force damage.

Hold Person. On a failed Wisdom Save (DC 13), Kelvin's target within 60' is paralyzed, but may make additional Wisdom Saves at the end of its turn to break the paralysis.

Roleplaying Information

The newest member of the Silver Hook, Kelvin is interested in broadening his adventuring horizons, and is happy to let most of the nefarious antics of his leader slide as long as Kelvin is not negatively affected.

Ideal: "Self-preservation is the most important preservation."
Bond: "I cherish my connection with my patron above all else."
Flaw: "My loyalty only goes as far as my own safety."

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Brugor

Medium humanoid (hill human), chaotic neutral

Armor Class: 13 (studded leather)
Hit Points: 27 (6d8)
Speed: 25'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (0)	13 (+1)	7 (-2)	13 (+1)	11 (0)	10 (0)

Skills: Investigation +6, Arcana +4
Senses: darkvision 60', passive Perception 14
Damage Resistances: poison
Languages: Common, Dwarvish

Optional Feat: Alert: Brugor gets a +5 to initiative rolls and cannot be surprised, and creatures hidden from him do not gain advantage on attack rolls against him.

Dwarven Resilience: Brugor has advantage on saving throws against poison.

Assassinate. Brugor has advantage on enemies who haven't taken any combat turns yet, and any successful hit on a surprised opponent is a critical hit.

Actions

Pickaxe, *Melee Weapon Attack*, +3 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d10) piercing damage, Brugor only uses this weapon with two hands.

Sneak Attack. If Brugor has advantage on an enemy or one of his allies is within 5' of an enemy target, Brugor deals an additional 10 damage (3d6) on a successful hit, once per turn.

Roleplaying Information

Stout and noisy, Brugor's affinity for drinking and for his pickaxe since his early years have prevented him from being as stealthy has he probably should be.

Ideal: "Take what's yours."
Bond: "My pickaxe is my only remaining possession from my father, and it is dear to me."
Flaw: "If I lose my pickaxe, re-obtaining it will be my paramount objective."



Lesindore

Medium humanoid (tiefling), chaotic neutral

Armor Class: 15 (chain shirt)
Hit Points: 48 (6d8 +21)
Speed: 35'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	18 (+4)	13 (+1)	8 (-1)	14 (+2)	10 (0)

Skills: Stealth +7, Acrobatics +4
Senses: darkvision 60', passive Perception 14
Damage Resistances: fire
Languages: Common, Infernal

Optional Feat: Observant: Lesindore can read the lips of anyone whose lips she can read. Additionally, her Wisdom score increases by 1.

Colossus Slayer: If a target enemy is below its hit point maximum, a successful hit allows Lesindore to deal an additional 4 (1d8) damage once per turn.

Actions

Longbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack*, +7 to hit, range 150'/600', one target. *Hit*: 8 (1d8+4) piercing damage.

Extra Attack. Lesindore can attack twice per round.

Roleplaying Information

Lesindore has been Gherhart's companion from the beginning of the Silver Hook, and is a faithful friend from his youth.

Ideal: "An oath is a commitment that cannot be broken"
Bond: "Gherhart is crazy, but I promised I would protect him."
Flaw: "I will protect Gherhart even if it comes to my own detriment."



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Emory Rightsfeld - Wight

Medium undead (Illuskan human), neutral evil

Armor Class: 15 (breastplate)
Hit Points: 50 (6d10 +20)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (0)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)

Skills: Stealth +4, Perception +3
Senses: darkvision 60', passive Perception 13
Damage Resistances: necrotic, bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from non-silvered, non-magical weapons
Damage Immunities: poison
Languages: Common, Goblin

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, Emory has disadvantage on attack rolls as well as Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions

Longsword, *Melee Weapon Attack,* +4 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit*: 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Life Drain*, Melee Weapon Attack*, +4 to hit, reach 5', one creature. *Hit*: 5 (1d6 +2) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces the hit point maximum to 0.
A humanoid slain by this attack rises 24 hours later as a zombie under the wight's control, unless the humanoid is restored to life or its body is destroyed. The wight can have no more than twelve zombies under its control at one time.

Extra Attack. Lesindore can attack twice per round.

Milli Quickstepp - Wight

Medium undead (lightfoot halfling), neutral evil

Armor Class: 15 (breastplate)
Hit Points: 50 (6d10 +20)
Speed: 25'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (0)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)

Skills: Stealth +4, Perception +3
Senses: darkvision 60', passive Perception 13
Damage Resistances: necrotic, bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from non-silvered, non-magical weapons
Damage Immunities: poison
Languages: Common, Goblin, Halfling

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, Milli has disadvantage on attack rolls as well as Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions

Longsword, *Melee Weapon Attack,* +4 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit*: 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Life Drain*, Melee Weapon Attack*, +4 to hit, reach 5', one creature. *Hit*: 5 (1d6 +2) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces the hit point maximum to 0.
A humanoid slain by this attack rises 24 hours later as a zombie under the wight's control, unless the humanoid is restored to life or its body is destroyed. The wight can have no more than twelve zombies under its control at one time.

Sneak Attack. If Milli has advantage on an enemy or one of her allies is within 5' of an enemy target, Milli deals an additional 10 damage (3d6) on a successful hit, once per turn.

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Brendan Highdale - Wight

Medium undead (Illuskan human), neutral evil

Armor Class: 15 (breastplate)
Hit Points: 50 (6d10 +20)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (0)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)

Skills: Stealth +4, Perception +3
Senses: darkvision 60', passive Perception 13
Damage Resistances: necrotic, bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from non-silvered, non-magical weapons
Damage Immunities: poison
Languages: Common, Goblin

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, Milli has disadvantage on attack rolls as well as Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Colossus Slayer. If a target enemy is below its hit point maximum, a successful hit allows Brendan to deal an additional 4 (1d8) damage once per turn.

Actions

Longsword, *Melee Weapon Attack,* +4 to hit, reach 5', one target. *Hit*: 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Life Drain*, Melee Weapon Attack*, +4 to hit, reach 5', one creature. *Hit*: 5 (1d6 +2) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces the hit point maximum to 0.
A humanoid slain by this attack rises 24 hours later as a zombie under the wight's control, unless the humanoid is restored to life or its body is destroyed. The wight can have no more than twelve zombies under its control at one time.

Gronni Eisenheart - Wight

Medium undead (hill dwarf), neutral evil

Armor Class: 15 (breastplate)
Hit Points: 50 (6d10 +20)
Speed: 30'

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (0)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)

Skills: Stealth +4, Perception +3
Senses: darkvision 60', passive Perception 13
Damage Resistances: necrotic, bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from non-silvered, non-magical weapons
Damage Immunities: poison
Languages: Common, Goblin, Dwarvish

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, Milli has disadvantage on attack rolls as well as Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions

Light Hammer. *Melee Weapon Attack*, +3 to hit, one target. *Hit:* 2 (1d4) bludgeoning damage.

Eldritch Blast. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +6 to hit, range 100', up to two targets. *Hit:* 5 (1d10) force damage.

Desecrated Flame. A single target within 60' must succeed on a Dexterity saving throw (DC 15) or take 9 (2d8) necrotic damage. The target gains no benefit of cover for this saving throw.

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